

D198

Global Arts and Humanities

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A university committee is sorting new courses into divisions. One course, taught by a professor who has published four books, asks students to interpret Japanese haiku and explain what they reveal about how people understand nature. Another campus already offers a botany course. Which division fits the haiku course?

- A. Studio fine arts, because the course studies poems.
- B. Social sciences.
- C. Humanities.
- D. Natural sciences.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A student researching the Harlem Renaissance visits a library that just renovated its reading room. She finds a 1926 poem by a Harlem writer, a 2015 textbook chapter on the movement, and a 1990 documentary about it. Which is a primary source?

- A. All three, since each is about the Harlem Renaissance.
- B. The 2015 textbook chapter.
- C. The 1926 poem.
- D. The 1990 documentary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item would be a secondary source for studying a 1960s folk music festival?

- A. The printed program handed out at the gate.
- B. An audio recording of a set at the festival.
- C. A performer's diary kept during the festival.
- D. A historian's 2010 article on the festival's influence.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An exchange student from a country where people often eat meals with their hands joins a dinner at her host family's home. The family has lived in the same town for four generations. One family member says eating with utensils is simply the correct, civilized way. Which concept does that remark show?

- A. Cultural diffusion.
- B. Ethnocentrism.
- C. Syncretism.
- D. Cultural relativism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A travel writer argues that a festival's customs should be understood by the meaning they hold within that culture rather than judged by the writer's home standards. Which concept is she applying?

- A. Moral relativism: no practice may ever be criticized.
- B. Cultural appropriation.
- C. Ethnocentrism.
- D. Cultural relativism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A music teacher who studied in Vienna plays the same note on a violin and then on a trumpet, at the same pitch and volume, for her class of 28 students. The students can still tell the instruments apart. Which element of music explains the difference?

- A. Timbre (tone color).
- B. Dynamics.
- C. Harmony.
- D. Pitch.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which change alters a piece's timbre while leaving its melody and rhythm the same?

- A.** Playing the tune much louder.
- B.** Playing the same tune on a flute instead of a guitar.
- C.** Moving the tune to a higher key.
- D.** Playing the tune twice as fast.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

At a celebration in a West African village with about 900 residents, a lead singer sings a line and the crowd answers with a repeated phrase. The songs have been passed down for generations without being written down. The event is held after the harvest. Which two features does this show?

- A.** A harvest ritual, so it is religion rather than music.
- B.** Call-and-response and oral tradition.
- C.** Free improvisation, since unwritten music has no fixed structure.
- D.** Polyphony and written notation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A music-streaming app with 50 million users recommends songs based on what each listener already plays. After a year, one user notices she hears only the same few genres. The app's logo was redesigned in the spring. Which Information Age effect is this?

- A.** An algorithmic filter bubble.
- B.** The digital divide.
- C.** Digital piracy.
- D.** Democratization of access.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Scholars describe a musical style that formed in the Caribbean when African drumming patterns merged with Spanish guitar forms and local church hymns. The style later became popular in dance halls in the 1950s. Which concept best describes how the style formed?

- A. Ethnocentrism.
- B. Commercialization.
- C. Syncretism.
- D. Cultural isolation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which example best shows syncretism?

- A. A festival that combines Indigenous harvest rites with saint's-day processions into one new celebration.
- B. The same smartphone model sold in 80 countries.
- C. A town that bans outside music from its festival.
- D. A folk dance performed exactly as it was 200 years ago.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A fashion brand based in a major city, whose sales rose 12% last year, sells T-shirts printed with a sacred Indigenous ceremonial symbol without consulting the community or explaining its meaning. Critics object. Which concept best frames the objection?

- A. Any use of another culture's art is always appropriation.
- B. Cultural diffusion.
- C. Cultural appreciation.
- D. Cultural appropriation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A university committee is sorting new courses into divisions. One course, ~~taught by a professor who has published four books~~, asks students to interpret Japanese haiku and explain what they reveal about how people understand nature. ~~Another campus already offers a botany course~~. Which division fits the haiku course?

Target word: division for the course **Decides:** The task is interpreting human expression and meaning.

A	Confusion set	Studio art is making work; interpreting literature is a humanities discipline.
B	Adjacent category	Social sciences study behavior with empirical methods such as surveys and data.
C	Correct	Interpreting poems and what they reveal about human thought is humanities work.
D	Camouflage	Answers the nature theme and the botany course; the method is interpretation, not experiment.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A student researching the Harlem Renaissance visits ~~a library that just renovated its reading room~~. She finds a 1926 poem by a Harlem writer, a 2015 textbook chapter on the movement, and a 1990 documentary about it. Which is a primary source?

Target word: identify the primary source **Decides:** Only the poem was created during the movement by a participant.

A	Absolute language	Being on the topic does not make a source primary.
B	Confusion set	A later analysis: secondary.
C	Correct	Made at the time by someone in the movement.
D	Adjacent category	Older than the textbook, but still made decades later about the movement.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

Which item would be a secondary source for studying a 1960s folk music festival?

Target word: reverse: find the secondary source **Decides:** A secondary source analyzes the event after the fact.

A	Adjacent category	An artifact of the event itself: primary.
B	Confusion set	A recording made at the event is primary evidence.
C	Inverted operation	Created by a participant at the time: primary.
D	Correct	Written later, interpreting the event.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An exchange student from a country where people often eat meals with their hands joins a dinner at her host family's home. ~~The family has lived in the same town for four generations~~. One family member says eating with utensils is simply the correct, civilized way. Which concept does that remark show?

Target word: name the concept **Decides:** Judging another culture's practice by one's own standard.

A	Adjacent category	Diffusion is the spread of traits, not a judgment about them.
B	Correct	Treats the home culture's custom as the universal standard.
C	Confusion set	Syncretism is blending traditions; nothing is blended here.
D	Inverted operation	Relativism would try to understand the practice in its own context.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A travel writer argues that a festival's customs should be understood by the meaning they hold within that culture rather than judged by the writer's home standards. Which concept is she applying?

Target word: reverse: from the stance to the label **Decides:** Understanding practices within their own context.

A	Absolute language	Cultural relativism is a method of understanding, not a ban on evaluation.
B	Confusion set	Appropriation is taking elements without consent or credit.
C	Inverted operation	Ethnocentrism judges by one's own standards, the opposite stance.
D	Correct	Seeks meaning from inside the culture.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A music teacher ~~who studied in Vienna~~ plays the same note on a violin and then on a trumpet, at the same pitch and volume, ~~for her class of 28 students~~. The students can still tell the instruments apart. Which element of music explains the difference?

Target word: element that differs **Decides:** Same pitch and volume, different sound source.

A	Correct	Timbre is the quality that distinguishes instruments on the same note.
B	Adjacent category	Dynamics is loudness, which was also held the same.
C	Dropped element	Harmony needs notes sounding together; only one note sounds at a time.
D	Confusion set	The pitch was held the same.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

Which change alters a piece's timbre while leaving its melody and rhythm the same?

Target word: reverse: from the element to an example **Decides:** Only the sound source should change.

A	Adjacent category	Changes dynamics, not tone color.
B	Correct	Same notes and timing, different tone color.
C	Inverted operation	Changes the pitches of the melody while keeping the same instrument's color.
D	Confusion set	Changes tempo and the timing of the rhythm.

8. Answer B Concept 5

At a celebration in a West African village ~~with about 900 residents~~, a lead singer sings a line and the crowd answers with a repeated phrase. The songs have been passed down for generations without being written down. ~~The event is held after the harvest~~. Which two features does this show?

Target word: name the two features **Decides:** Leader-and-group exchange; songs learned by ear.

A	Camouflage	The occasion does not change the musical features being asked about.
B	Correct	Leader and chorus alternate, and the songs are transmitted by ear.
C	Absolute language	Oral music can be highly structured, as the repeated response shows.
D	Inverted operation	The songs were never written down.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A music-streaming app with 50 million users recommends songs based on what each listener already plays. After a year, one user notices she hears only the same few genres. The app's logo was redesigned in the spring. Which Information Age effect is this?

Target word: name the effect **Decides:** Recommendations based on past choices narrow exposure.

A	Correct	Personalization feeds back past taste and shrinks the range heard.
B	Adjacent category	The divide is unequal access to technology; she has access.
C	Confusion set	Piracy is unauthorized copying, unrelated to recommendations.
D	Inverted operation	Access widened, but her exposure narrowed.

10. Answer C Concept 7

Scholars describe a musical style that formed in the Caribbean when African drumming patterns merged with Spanish guitar forms and local church hymns. The style later became popular in dance halls in the 1950s. Which concept best describes how the style formed?

Target word: how the style formed **Decides:** Several traditions blended into a new form.

A	Confusion set	A judgment about other cultures, not a process of blending.
B	Camouflage	Answers the dance-hall popularity, which came later.
C	Correct	Blending distinct traditions into something new.
D	Inverted operation	Isolation keeps traditions apart; these merged.

11. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

Which example best shows syncretism?

Target word: reverse: from the concept to an example **Decides:** Traditions must blend into a new form.

A	Correct	Two traditions merge into a new practice.
B	Adjacent category	Diffusion of a product, with no blending of traditions.
C	Confusion set	Cultural isolation, the opposite of blending.
D	Inverted operation	Preservation without blending.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A fashion brand based in a major city, whose sales rose 12% last year, sells T-shirts printed with a sacred Indigenous ceremonial symbol without consulting the community or explaining its meaning. Critics object. Which concept best frames the objection?

Target word: concept behind the objection **Decides:** Sacred element used for profit without consent, credit, or context.

A	Absolute language	Respectful, credited exchange is appreciation, not appropriation.
B	Adjacent category	Diffusion is neutral spread; the objection is about consent and sacred meaning.
C	Inverted operation	Appreciation involves respect, consent, and context, which are missing.
D	Correct	Taking a sacred element without permission or understanding.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	What the humanities study	The humanities interpret human expression and meaning (literature, art, music, philosophy, history) through analysis and interpretation rather than controlled experiment.	Filing anything about nature or society under the sciences because of its subject.	Is the task to interpret meaning, or to measure and test?
2	Primary vs. secondary sources	A primary source was created at the time or by a participant; a secondary source analyzes or describes it later.	Treating any old item, or any item on the topic, as primary.	Who made it, and when relative to the event.
3	Ethnocentrism vs. cultural relativism	Ethnocentrism judges other cultures by one's own standards; cultural relativism understands practices within their own cultural context.	Reading relativism as “no practice can ever be questioned.”	Judging as “correct” or “civilized” vs. seeking meaning from inside the culture.
4	Elements of music	Pitch = high or low; rhythm = timing of sounds; melody = a tune of successive pitches; harmony = notes sounding together; dynamics = loudness; timbre = tone color.	Calling the difference between instruments on the same note pitch or volume.	“Same note, same volume, different instrument.”
5	Oral tradition and call-and-response	Much of the world's music is passed down by ear; call-and-response (a leader's line answered by a group) is central to West African and African diasporic music.	Assuming music without notation lacks structure.	A leader and a group alternating; songs learned by ear across generations.
6	Humanities in the Information Age	Digital media widens access to culture but algorithmic curation can narrow what each person sees (filter bubbles).	Assuming more available content always means broader exposure.	Recommendations based on past choices; a shrinking range of content.
7	Cultural diffusion and syncretism	Diffusion is the spread of cultural traits; syncretism is the blending of traditions into a new form.	Calling any spread of a product syncretism, or calling a blend isolation.	Two or more traditions merging into something new.
8	Appropriation vs. appreciation	Appropriation takes elements of a culture, especially sacred ones, without permission, credit, or understanding; appreciation engages with respect, context, and credit.	Treating all cross-cultural borrowing as either always fine or always wrong.	Sacred or significant elements used commercially without consent or context.

Course scope (public description): This is a Global Arts and Humanities course that contains three modules with corresponding lessons. This course is an invitation to see the world through the humanities, examine the humanities during the Information Age, and explore the global origins of music—essentially questioning what makes us human, and how people are connected across culture and time. Each module includes learning opportunities through readings, videos, audio, and other relevant resources. Assessment activities with feedback also provide opportunities to practice and check learning. With no prior knowledge or experience, a learner can expect to spend 30-40 hours on the course content.